

Actual business information

When searching for local businesses nearby, you may have noticed that sometimes, some of the businesses around don't show up in the search or maps. Imagine you own an Italian restaurant and there is a potential customer around. The customer searches for 'restaurants near me' and you don't show up, but your competitor does. What did you do to deserve showing up lower among the search rankings? What did your competitor do differently? Easy! Just go to Google My Business and fill up your business information there. Make sure you do not skip the following:

1. Verifying your location (you will also start showing up on maps)
2. Updating your operation timing
3. Responding to reviews
4. Adding photographs (everybody prefers websites and pages with visuals)

Google will then be able to determine your relevance, distance and prominence, thereby ranking you in the search results accordingly. You won't lose customers because you didn't show up in the 'Near me' section.

Technical SEO

Along with a well coded website, optimising your content for SEO is equally important. When crawling websites, Google looks for keywords to index the site. Take care of the following, at the minimum:

1. Use keywords in your page titles, because it is the first place that Google looks at. If you have noticed, the page title also happens to be the first line to come up in website search results.
2. Use header tags to show hierarchy. (Apart from being a good SEO

practice, this is also a big aspect of accessibility compliance.)

3. Maintain a meta description of what your website has to offer. This should be short and precise. It must be able to get users to distinctly identify with your website and convince them why your website is what they are really looking for. More importantly, include keywords in your description. Nowadays, Google shows missing keywords with a strike through for the website, which is unsettling, for the user might perceive that you do not have what they are looking for.
4. Optimise your images for SEO. Do not forget your image alts. The alt tags must include information of what the image is and its relevance. This bumps up your ranking on Google image search as well.

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